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Search Committee
Department of Economics
University of Pittsburgh
Pittsburgh, PA 15260
USA

Dear Members of the Search Committee,

I am writing to express my interest in the Assistant Professor position in Economics at the University of Pittsburgh, to commence Fall 2026. I am a Ph.D. candidate in Economics at Johns Hopkins University, advised by Professors Christopher D. Carroll, Nicholas W. Papageorge, and Stelios Fourakis, and I expect to receive my degree in May 2026. My research fields are macroeconomics, wealth and income dynamics, and computational economics.

My research agenda is unified by a focus on understanding the determinants of wealth inequality and the mechanisms through which heterogeneity in returns to wealth shapes aggregate outcomes. In my job-market paper, I estimate the degree of heterogeneity in individual portfolio returns using micro-data from the Survey of Consumer Finances and simulate a structural model in which households face idiosyncratic return risk. I show that allowing for persistent heterogeneity in returns substantially improves the model's ability to match the empirical distribution of wealth, offering a tractable way to connect micro-level return dispersion to macroeconomic inequality.

In a second project, I use the Health and Retirement Study to study the relationship between interpersonal trust and portfolio performance. Building on the literature that finds a hump-shaped relationship between trust and income, I show that a similar relationship holds for individual returns to wealth measured in the HRS data, highlighting a behavioral channel through which social attitudes shape saving and investment outcomes. This work also provides new estimates of the persistent component of returns to net worth, which motivate the calibration of heterogeneity in my structural model.

The University of Pittsburgh's Department of Economics places a strong emphasis on rigorous scholarship, teaching excellence, and the generation of research with relevance to policy and macro-financial dynamics. My empirical and computational strengths align well with this mission, and I am eager to contribute to the department's goals of advancing macroeconomic understanding and engaging both undergraduate and graduate students in meaningful research.

Teaching. My teaching experience centers on undergraduate macroeconomics and an upper-level macro policy seminar, where I have led weekly discussion sections and held regular office hours for classes ranging from 16 to 40 students. My approach is student-centered: I aim to help students "convince themselves" that they have moved from confusion to understanding by holding structured office-hour coaching that builds trust and confidence. At Pittsburgh, I am prepared to teach *Principles of Macroeconomics*, *Intermediate Macroeconomic Theory*, *Money and Banking*, and

Quantitative Methods for Economics. I would also welcome developing electives such as *Economics of Inequality and Tax Policy* or *Computational Macroeconomics and Policy*, emphasizing reproducible workflows and evidence-based decision-making.

I believe I would be a strong fit because my computational and empirical toolkit allows me to (i) produce robust, data-backed estimates of returns and distributional outcomes, (ii) build and validate models that speak to macroeconomic and policy-relevant questions, and (iii) collaborate across teams and engage students in research and teaching. I am enthusiastic about the opportunity to join the University of Pittsburgh's community and contribute to its teaching, research, and service missions.

I would be honored to contribute to the University of Pittsburgh's Department of Economics and to mentor students pursuing quantitative careers in economics and business. Thank you for your consideration; I welcome the opportunity to discuss my fit with your department at your convenience.

Sincerely,

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